

CHAPTER 06

LANGUAGES



MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS

1. The word "Urdu" is derived from _____.
2. The number of languages spoken in Pakistan is more than _____.
3. The poetic collection of Shah Abdul Latif is called _____.
4. Sachal Sarmast was a poet of the _____ language.
5. Rahman Baba was a famous poet of the _____ language.
6. "Heer Ranjha" was written by _____.
7. The first Urdu poet to have a Deewan was _____.
8. The earliest form of literature is called _____.
9. The Sindhi writing system is based on _____.

SHORT ANSWERS

URDU LANGUAGE

Introductory Remarks:

Language is the primary medium through which individuals convey their ideas and emotions. It plays a crucial role in shaping both personal character and national identity. Language fosters unity, creates a sense of belonging, and bridges the gaps between different communities.

In Pakistan, multiple regional languages are spoken, the prominent ones being Pashto, Punjabi, Sindhi, Balochi, and Kashmiri. However, Urdu is the national language and holds a unique position as a symbol of national cohesion.

Importance of Urdu in National Life:

1. Symbol of Brotherhood and Unity:

Pakistan is one nation, and its people share common goals and values. National unity is essential for progress, and Urdu acts as a key factor in unifying the diverse population of the country.

2. Medium of Expression:

Urdu serves as a powerful tool for expressing thoughts, emotions, and aspirations. It enables communication between individuals from different regions, helping them understand each other's perspectives.

3. Language of Communication and Coordination:

Urdu functions as a common language that connects the provinces of Pakistan. Despite the presence of various regional languages, Urdu unites the people under one linguistic banner, preserving national solidarity.

4. National and Official Language:

On March 21, 1948, Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah declared Urdu as the national and official language of Pakistan, highlighting its central role in the country's administrative and cultural affairs.

Conclusion:

As the national language, Urdu is a vital element in maintaining unity across Pakistan. Government offices are increasingly adopting Urdu for official communication. Institutions like the Urdu Development Board and Anjuman-e-Taraqqi-e-Urdu are promoting its use, and efforts continue to ensure Urdu secures its rightful place in all sectors of society.

SINDHI LANGUAGE

Introduction:

Sindhi is one of the major regional languages of Pakistan, historically spoken in the Indus Delta region. Scholars suggest that the language used by the people of the ancient Mohenjo-Daro civilization contained elements of modern Sindhi.

Dialects:

Sindhi has several dialects, including Surili, Wacholi, Laadi, Thari, Kohistani, and Laasi. Despite regional variations, the core language remains consistent.

Famous Sindhi Poets:

- Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai
- Sachal Sarmast
- Makhdoom Noor
- Shah Inayat
- Bedil
- Sabit Ali Shah
- Kazi Kazah

PUNJABI LANGUAGE

Introduction:

Punjabi is the language of the Punjab province and traces its roots to the ancient Aryan language, Prakrit. Over time, it incorporated words from Persian, Arabic, and Turkish.

Dialects:

Punjabi is divided into Eastern (e.g., Bhatyani, Rathi, Maavi) and Western (e.g., Saraiki, Pothohari, Dhani, Sitara-Puri, Jangli) dialects. Regardless of dialect, the foundational structure of the language remains the same.

Famous Punjabi Poets:

Punjabi is known for its rich tradition of Sufi and romantic poetry. Renowned poets include:

- Baba Farid
- Shaikh Ibrahim Farid Sani
- Madhu Lal Hussain
- Sultan Bahu
- Bulleh Shah
- Ali Haider
- Waris Shah

BALOCHI LANGUAGE

Introduction:

Balochi is the regional language of Balochistan and is considered the least developed among Pakistan's regional languages. It spread through Balochi tribes who migrated from Iran.

Historical Periods of Balochi Literature:

1. Early Medieval Period (1430–1600)
2. Later Medieval Period (1600–1850)
3. Modern Period (1850–1930)
4. Contemporary Period (1930–present)

Different accent of Balochi:

- Sulemani (Eastern Balochistan)
- Makrani (Western Balochistan)
- Rakhshani

Famous Poets and Literary Figures:

- Azad Jamalddini
- Ulfat Naseem
- Abdul Qadir Shahwani
- Malaki Mohammad Ramzan
- Mir Aqil Maingal
- Jam Darag
- Shah Mureed
- Shahdab

PASHTO LANGUAGE

Introduction:

Pashto is spoken in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and the tribal areas. It belongs to the Eastern Iranian branch and includes vocabulary from Persian, Arabic, Greek, and Pehlevi.

Dialects:

Pashto is primarily divided into two dialects:

- Yousafzai (spoken in northern regions)
- Kandhari/Khatak (spoken in southern regions)

Famous Pashto Poets:

- Amir Karoro
- Khushal Khan Khattak
- Rehman Baba
- Sher Shah Suri
- Saifullah
- Kazim Kazim

KASHMIRI LANGUAGE

Introduction:

Kashmiri is spoken in Azad Jammu & Kashmir and Indian-occupied Kashmir. It evolved from Sanskrit and is commonly used by Muslim communities in the region. The language contains many words from Persian, Arabic, and Turkish, and is written in the Persian script.

Dialects:

- Salmanki
- Gandhoro
- Gaami

Notable Literary Figures:

Kashmiri literature began with folk songs and poetry. Prominent literary figures include:

- Shah Noudin
- Khatoon Lillah Anifa
- Baba Nasiruddin
- Ghani

DESCRIPTIVE ANSWERS

URDU LANGUAGE

Introduction:

Language is the primary medium for expressing ideas, thoughts, and emotions. It plays a significant role in shaping the personality of an individual and in the development of national character. Language fosters unity, brings people closer, and cultivates harmony within a society.

In Pakistan, several regional languages are spoken, including Pushto, Punjabi, Sindhi, Balochi, and Kashmiri. However, the national language that unites the entire country is Urdu.

Urdu – The National Language of Pakistan:

After the independence of Pakistan in 1947, Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah declared that Urdu would be the national language of the country. On 21st March 1948, he said:

"Let me make it clear that the national language of Pakistan is going to be Urdu and no other language. Without one state language, no nation can remain tied up solidly together."

This declaration reflects the importance of Urdu in maintaining national unity and identity.

Qualities of Urdu Language:

1. Great Power of Assimilation:

Urdu has the remarkable ability to absorb vocabulary from other languages such as Arabic, Persian, Turkish, and even English. This adaptability has helped Urdu to evolve and gain wide acceptance across diverse linguistic communities in Pakistan. As Sir Syed Ahmed Khan stated:

"Still now, Urdu has great affinity for many other words and ideas which increases its beauty."

2. Source of National Identity:

Language is a major symbol of a nation's identity. While abroad, Pakistanis are identified not just by their nationality but also by their ability to communicate in Urdu, reinforcing a sense of pride and belonging.

3. Rich Literary Heritage:

Urdu boasts a rich collection of prose and poetry. Renowned literary figures such as Allama Iqbal, Mirza Ghalib, Shibli Nomani, Maulana Hali, Ameer Khusro, and Sir Syed Ahmed Khan contributed significantly to Urdu literature and the cultural awakening of the Muslims of the subcontinent.

4. International Language:

According to UNESCO, Urdu is spoken and understood in many parts of the world, especially in South Asia, the Middle East, Europe, and North America, by expatriate Pakistani communities.

Importance of Urdu in National Life:

1. Symbol of Unity and Brotherhood:

Urdu plays a key role in unifying people from different linguistic and ethnic backgrounds. It bridges the gap between the diverse regions of Pakistan, creating a shared identity.

2. Medium of Expression:

Urdu provides a common platform for expressing national sentiment, cultural values, and religious thoughts. It enables communication between people from various provinces.

3. Tool for Communication and Coordination:

As the national language, Urdu ensures effective communication in government institutions, media, education, and public life, promoting coordination among provinces.

4. Official and Administrative Language:

Urdu is used in official government communications and is being increasingly adopted in administrative affairs. The government has issued an Urdu terminology dictionary to standardize its use in office work.

5. Medium of Instruction:

Urdu is the primary medium of instruction in schools and colleges across Pakistan. Subjects such as Pakistan Studies, Islamic Studies, and History are taught in Urdu at various academic levels.

6. Cultural Heritage:

Urdu is deeply rooted in the Indo-Islamic civilization. It flourished under the Mughals and was embraced by Muslims and Hindus alike. It has become a symbol of Pakistan's cultural legacy.

Conclusion:

Urdu is not only a language but a powerful force of national integration. It strengthens the sociopolitical fabric of Pakistan by uniting different regions under a common linguistic umbrella. Institutions such as the Urdu Development Board and Anjuman-e-Taraqqi-e-Urdu are actively working to promote and preserve the language. With proper policies and public support, Urdu is expected to further establish itself in all sectors of national life.

REGIONAL LANGUAGES OF PAKISTAN

Introduction:

Pakistan is a multi-ethnic and multilingual country. According to linguistic surveys, over 30 languages and dialects are spoken across the country. Among them, five major regional languages — Punjabi, Sindhi, Pushto, Balochi, and Kashmiri — hold special cultural and historical importance. These languages are not only means of communication but are rich in folk traditions, poetry, music, and literature.

Punjabi Language:

- **Origin:** Spoken in Punjab, it originated from the Aryan language 'Prakrit'. Over time, it incorporated elements from Arabic, Persian, and Turkish.
- **Dialects:** Two main groups — Eastern (Bhatyani, Rathi, Maavali) and Western (Saraiki, Pothwari, Dhani, Jangli, Siraiki).
- **Famous Poets:**
 - Baba Farid Ganj Shakar
 - Waris Shah (author of Heer Ranjha)
 - Bulleh Shah
 - Sultan Bahu
 - Madhu Lal Hussain

Sindhi Language:

- **Origin:** A historic language of Sindh, with roots dating back to the Indus Valley Civilization. Elements of Sindhi were spoken during the Moen-jo-Daro era.
- **Dialects:** Surili, Laadi, Wacholi, Thari, Kohistani, Laasi.
- **Famous Poets:**
 - Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai (spiritual poetry)
 - Sachal Sarmast

- Bedil
- Sabit Ali Shah

Balochi Language:

- **Origin:** Spoken in Balochistan, it is the least developed but one of the oldest regional languages. It came with Baloch tribes from Iran.
- **Literary Periods:**
 - Early Medieval (1430–1600)
 - Later Medieval (1600–1850)
 - Modern (1850–1930)
 - Contemporary (1930–Present)
- **Types:** Sulemani, Makrani, Rakhshani.
- **Famous Poets:**
 - Azad Jamaldini
 - Ulfat Naseem
 - Shah Mureed
 - Shahdab

Pushto Language:

- **Origin:** Regional language of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and tribal areas. It is of East Iranian origin and includes Persian, Pehlevi, Arabic, and Greek vocabulary.
- **Dialects:**
 - Yousafzai (Northern)
 - Kandhari/Khatak (Southern)
- **Famous Poets:**
 - Khushal Khan Khattak
 - Rehman Baba
 - Amir Karoro

Kashmiri Language:

- **Origin:** Derived from Sanskrit, spoken in Azad Kashmir and Indian-occupied Kashmir. Contains Turkish, Arabic, and Persian words.
- **Script:** Written in the Persian script.
- **Dialects:** Salmanki, Gandhoro, Gaami.
- **Famous Writers:**
 - Shah Nooruddin
 - Khatoon Lillah Anifa
 - o Baba Nasiruddin

Conclusion:

The regional languages of Pakistan are an essential part of the nation's cultural identity. They reflect the diversity and richness of our society. While Urdu unifies the nation, regional languages preserve the local heritage and traditions. The government's promotion of regional TV channels and inclusion of local languages in the educational curriculum is a positive step towards linguistic development and national cohesion.